QCert: Verifying and Extending Quantum Circuit Completeness in Agda and Lean

ANONYMOUS AUTHOR(S)

A set of circuit equations is complete if every equation between circuits denoting the same linear map follows from it, and minimal if no equation can be derived from the others. Establishing these properties takes long case analyses spanning hundreds of pages, making the details hard to check by hand. To address this, we extend an existing formalization library to QCert in Agda and Lean. In QCert, humans set up a unified framework of circuits, matrix semantics, and group presentations, and state each paper's main theorem in it. LLM coding agents then write the proofs following the papers' arguments, and the proof assistant checks them. A human therefore need only review each paper's relations, gate semantics, and theorem statement. Using QCert, we first check sixteen published results, fifteen on completeness and one on minimality. They cover discrete gate sets such as Clifford, Clifford+T, and Toffoli–Hadamard, on qubits or qudits of every odd prime dimension. We verify fourteen of them directly and correct an error in each of the other two. We also obtain complete equational theories for circuits over $\{X, CX, CCX\}$ and for Toffoli–Hadamard circuits. We expect QCert to help with other open completeness problems, such as those for quantum circuits in higher dimensions.

1 Introduction

Rewriting of quantum circuits is a ubiquitous tool in circuit optimization [36, 44, 45, 56], equivalence checking [57], hardware mapping [54], and reasoning about quantum programs [26]. This relies on an *equational theory* for a family of quantum circuits, a set of rewrite rules that transform a circuit into an equivalent one. Such a theory should be *sound* so that every rewrite preserves the underlying linear map. It should also be *complete* so that any equivalence between circuits can be derived. Additionally, we want it to be *minimal*, with no redundant rules. Completeness and minimality proofs often involve long case analyses and supporting derivations spanning hundreds of pages [20, 26, 38]. Such arguments are difficult to check by hand: a rule may appear redundant even though its derivation indirectly relies on that same rule. A proof assistant checks these dependencies and rejects circular arguments.

Our contributions. We present QCert, a framework in Agda [15, 47] and Lean [24] for representing and verifying quantum circuit completeness and minimality results. Figure 1 summarises its workflow: humans check that the formal definitions, relations, and theorem statement faithfully express the source paper; LLM coding agents formalize the proof, and Lean or Agda checks it.

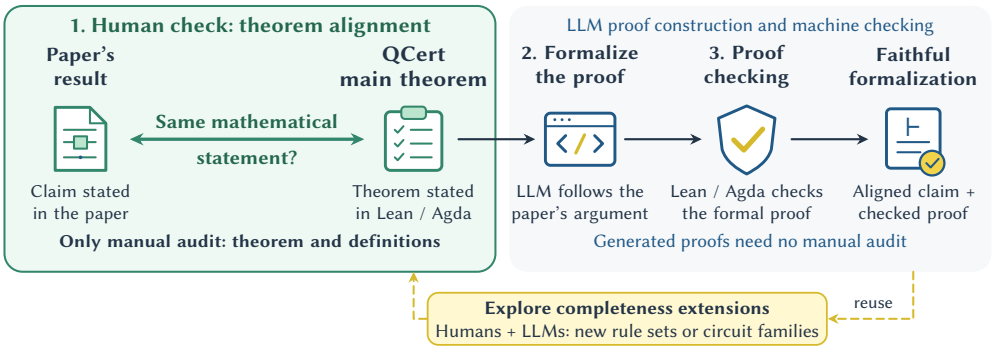


Fig. 1. QCert's workflow. The main path checks published results; the dashed branch reuses the verified libraries to explore new completeness results. Proposed extensions return to the same review and proof-checking steps.

The statement being checked must also match the intended result [35]. For example, Bastounis et al. [6] identify mistranslations in a claimed Navier–Stokes formalization that weakened the statement being verified. QCert therefore keeps the definitions and theorem statements under human review while the proof assistant checks the proofs.

Using this workflow, we formalize sixteen published results in both Agda and Lean, verifying fourteen directly and correcting an error in each of the other two (Section 6). The Lean formalizations use Mathlib's standard definitions, making their statements easier to compare with the source papers (Section 3.3).

The common infrastructure builds on the library of circuits and presentations of Bian and Feng [7]. The qudit Clifford case study formalizes the result of Bian, Li et al. [8] using reusable components (Section 4).

Most of the sixteen results concern restricted Clifford+T circuits or their matrix groups, and QCert reuses the mathematical structure they share. Amy et al. [2] characterise several restricted gate sets by unitary matrices over subrings of $\mathbb{Z}[1/\sqrt{2}, i]$, with ancillas where needed. Figure 2 displays these gate sets, their matrix groups, and multi-level generators. These connections allow QCert to share exact arithmetic, matrix semantics, group constructions, and completeness arguments across formalizations. Figure 9 returns to this diagram in Section 5 to show the status of complete relations and their verification.

Using the dashed branch of Figure 1, we have obtained complete equational theories for circuits over $\{X, CX, CCX\}$ and for Toffoli–Hadamard circuits.

Related work. Complete equational theories are known for reversible [27, 37], Clifford [8, 38, 43, 53], and CNOT-dihedral circuits [1], as well as several restricted Clifford+T families [3, 10, 11, 20], and universal quantum circuits [22, 23]. Presentations of the underlying multi-level matrix groups support several of these results [9, 26, 31, 39]. Minimal theories are also known for several fragments and for all quantum circuits [14, 21]. Most of the sixteen results that QCert checks are among these (Section 5).

Mechanized quantum compilers and program logics establish program correctness or the soundness of circuit transformations [17, 36, 48, 59]. The mechanized completeness results for Π and its square-root extension are coherence arguments [16, 18]. Human-supervised, AI-assisted workflows have also formalized quantum program logics, algorithms, and components of interactive proofs [40, 50, 58]. QCert focuses on completeness and minimality of circuit equational theories.

Orientation. Sections 2 and 3 introduce the proof strategies and QCert framework, and Section 4 illustrates them through multi-qupit Clifford completeness. Sections 5 and 6 describe the formalized results and source corrections, followed by limitations and future work in Section 7.

2 Background

A circuit is a word over an alphabet $\mathcal{G}$ of gates. A rewrite rule is then a relation between words over this alphabet, and a rule set $\mathcal{R}$ generates a congruence on circuits. To a circuit C we associate an *interpretation* $[\![C]\!]$, which is its underlying matrix. The completeness results we formalize have matrix entries in the finitely generated rings $\mathbb{Z}\left[1/\sqrt{2}, i\right]$, $\mathbb{Z}\left[1/2, i\right]$, $\mathbb{Z}\left[1/\sqrt{2}\right]$, and $\mathbb{Z}\left[1/2\right]$, which make them exactly representable in Agda. We leave the formalization of universal circuits taking values in $\mathbb{C}$ for future work.

There are two main strategies for proving completeness of a rule set $\mathcal{R}$ over a gate set $\mathcal{G}$, both of which we support. Consider any two circuits C_1 and C_2 over $\mathcal{G}$ that have the same linear map, $[\![C_1]\!] = [\![C_2]\!]$. We need to show that C_1 can be rewritten into C_2 using $\mathcal{R}$. Figure 3a outlines the first strategy. It specifies a unique normal form for each linear map [1, 8, 13, 27, 28, 37, 38, 43, 51, 53],

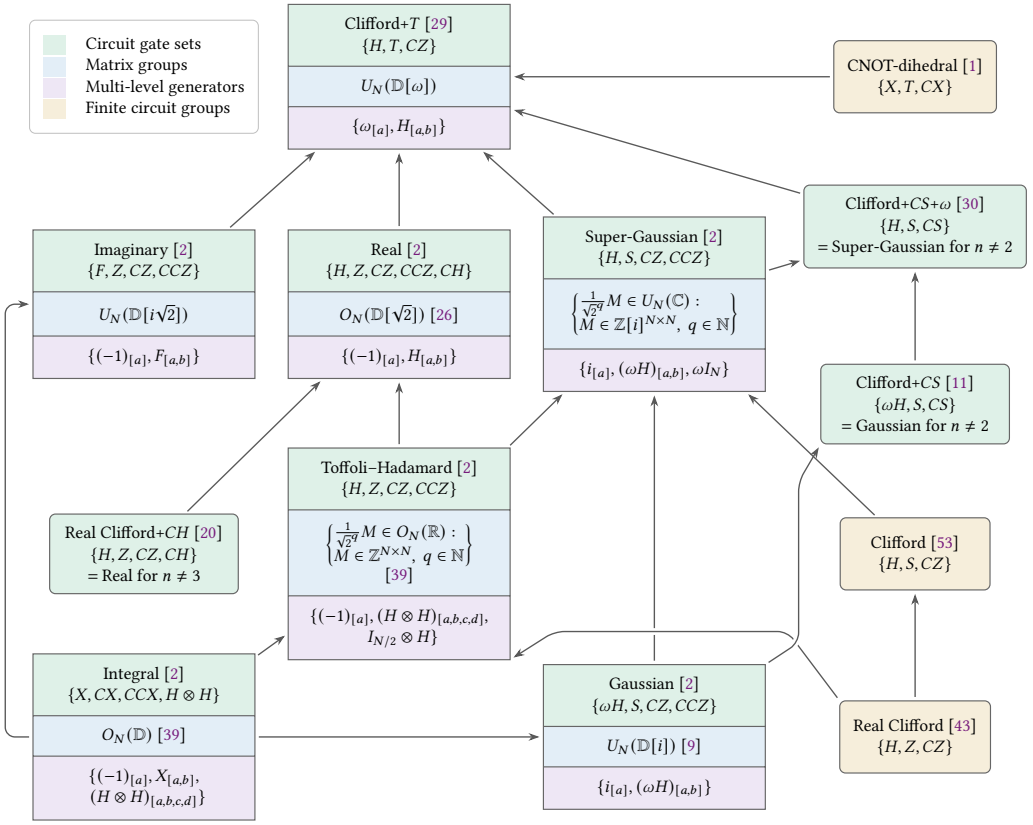
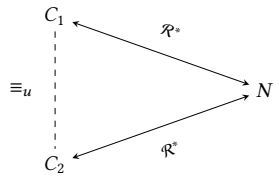


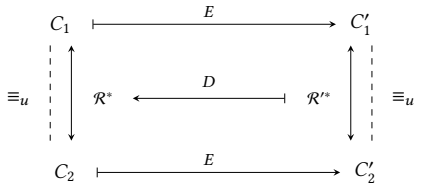
Fig. 2. Restricted Clifford+T circuit families and their underlying matrix groups, with $N = 2^n$ and $n \geq 1$. Each three-part box lists circuit gates, the group they represent with at most one clean ancilla, and reduced multi-level generators for that group. Without ancillas, the circuit group may be smaller. Arrows denote inclusion of ancilla-free circuit groups and, where shown, matrix groups. Mint-only boxes mark when related circuit groups agree; each exceptional inclusion is strict. Ivory boxes are finite circuit groups. Here $\mathbb{D} = \mathbb{Z}[1/2]$, $\omega = e^{i\pi/4}$, $F = (H + iI)/\sqrt{2}$, and q ranges over nonnegative integers. Subscripts specify distinct basis levels; $I_{N/2} \otimes H$ and ωI_N act globally. In both Gaussian cases, $X_{[a,b]} = (\omega H)_{[a,b]} i^2_{[b]} (\omega H)^\dagger_{[a,b]}$ is redundant. Clifford+CS+ω denotes adjoining the scalar ω to Clifford+CS.

often by giving an exact synthesis algorithm [9, 19, 26, 31, 39]. Completeness follows by proving that every circuit can be transformed into its normal form using the rewrite rules. By uniqueness, C_1 and C_2 have the same normal form N. Reversing the path from C_2 to N and concatenating it with the path from C_1 to N then gives the desired path of rewrites.

Figure 3b illustrates the second strategy, which uses an already complete rule set $\mathcal{R}'$ over a different gate set $\mathcal{G}'$ [3, 10–12, 14, 20, 22, 23, 25, 52]. Here, E and D translate circuits from $\mathcal{G}$ to $\mathcal{G}'$ and back, replacing each gate with a circuit over the other gate set. Both E and D preserve circuit composition and the underlying linear map. To transfer completeness from $\mathcal{R}'$ to $\mathcal{R}$, we first show that every rule of $\mathcal{R}'$, translated by D, can be derived using $\mathcal{R}$. We can then replace each step of the proof between C'_1 and C'_2 by its translated derivation, giving $D(C'_1) \overset{\mathcal{R}^*}{\longleftrightarrow} D(C'_2)$. It then remains to prove that the rewrite $C_j \overset{\mathcal{R}^*}{\longleftrightarrow} D(C'_j)$ is derivable, for which it suffices to prove the round-trip



(a) The rewrites from C_1 and C_2 to their common normal form N using $\mathcal{R}$ give rewrites from C_1 to C_2 using $\mathcal{R}$.



(b) Completeness of $\mathcal{R}'$ gives rewrites between $C_1' = E(C_1)$ and $C_2' = E(C_2)$. Translating this proof back gives rewrites between C_1 and C_2 using $\mathcal{R}$.

Fig. 3. Two strategies for proving completeness of $\mathcal{R}$ over a gate set $\mathcal{G}$. $\overset{\mathcal{R}^*}{\longleftrightarrow}$ means applying a finite sequence of rewrites using $\mathcal{R}$ in either direction, where $*$ denotes zero or more steps.

rewrites $g \overset{\mathcal{R}^*}{\longleftrightarrow} D(E(g))$ for each $g \in \mathcal{G}$. Sometimes the two strategies are combined, as in the scaled dyadic extension of [39].

The exact synthesis results used by the first strategy present groups of matrices rather than circuits (the first block of Table 1). Their generators are *multi-level* matrices. For an $m \times m$ matrix M and distinct indices $a_1, \ldots, a_m$ in $\{0, \ldots, n-1\}$, the *m-level* matrix $M_{[a_1,\ldots,a_m]}$ is the $n \times n$ matrix that acts as M on the standard basis vectors $e_{a_1}, \ldots, e_{a_m}$ and as the identity on the others. For example, $(-1)_{[a]}$ negates e_a, and $\mathrm{X}_{[a,b]}$ exchanges e_a and e_b. Circuits on k qubits have matrices of dimension $n = 2^k$, but these groups are defined in every dimension n. We introduce multi-level matrices for two reasons. The gap we find in Section 6 is in a presentation by one- and two-level matrices [26], and our Toffoli–Hadamard completeness result builds on a presentation by one-, two-, and four-level matrices [39].

For proofs based on exact synthesis, QCert supplies the common induction argument. Each development proves a Main Lemma connecting the algorithm's reduction steps to the rewrite rules. This isolates the algorithm-specific case analysis—the main work in each formalization—from the reusable completeness proof. Appendix C gives the argument.

Starting from a complete rule set, we can remove a redundant rule by deriving it from the other rules, thereby preserving completeness. To show that the resulting rule set is minimal, we need to give, for each remaining rule R, an interpretation of circuits that every other rule preserves but R does not. Any derivation using the other rules preserves this interpretation, so R cannot be derived from them [14, 21].

3 The QCert Framework

Our Agda framework QCert states every completeness theorem as a group presentation. Gates are indexed by their arity, the number of wires on which they act. Each source relation is stated on its original wires, and shared *structural rules* allow it to be used inside a larger circuit. These rules are independent of the gate set and make explicit the circuit structure that source papers often leave implicit.

We associate to circuits a matrix semantics $[\![-]\!]$ with entries in a finitely generated ring such as $\mathbb{Z}\left[1/\sqrt{2}, i\right]$. This defines a group homomorphism to a unitary matrix group G, whose group structure is checked once per ring using Agda's standard library. QCert extends the interpretation from gates to circuits and proves the structural rules sound once for all gate sets. For soundness, each development then needs to check only its own rules.

Soundness and completeness say the relations present the image of $[\![-]\!]$, which is the subgroup of G generated by the gates. In Agda, mathematical structures such as groups are defined as records.

The record $\mathcal{R}$ IsSubPresentationOf G contains the semantics $[\![-]\!]$, with proofs of soundness and completeness. The record $\mathcal{R}$ IsPresentationOf G adds surjectivity, so the relations present all of G.

Figure 4 summarizes the two obligations: checking each rule's matrix equality for soundness, and deriving a known complete rule set $\mathcal{T}$ from $\mathcal{R}$ for completeness.

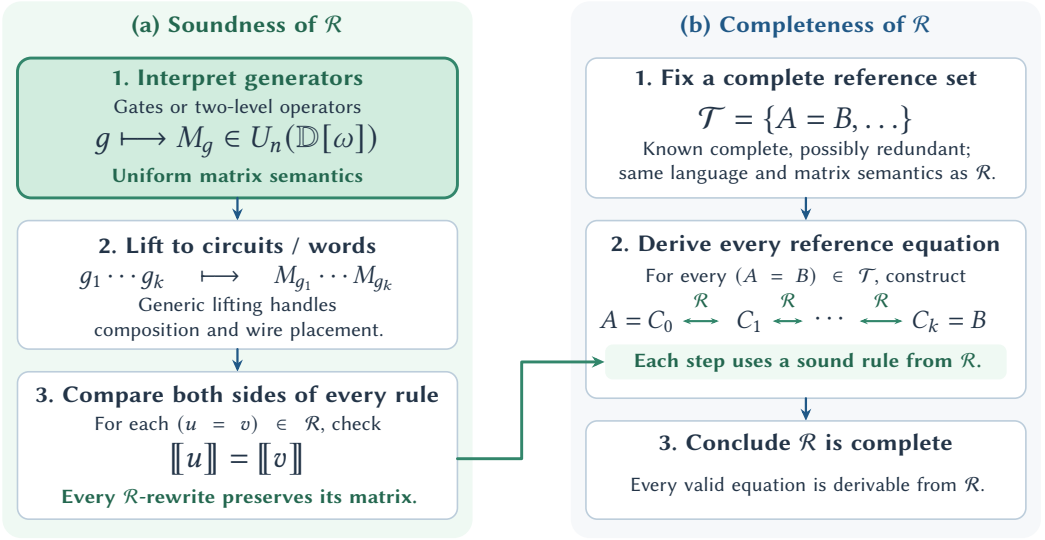


Fig. 4. QCert's shared matrix interpretation supports both proof obligations. The left column checks every rule of $\mathcal{R}$; the right derives every rule of a known complete set $\mathcal{T}$ in the same circuit language and matrix semantics. Each rewrite step uses a rule of $\mathcal{R}$, whose soundness is checked on the left. The displayed $U_n(\mathbb{D}[\omega])$ covers qubit fragments [2], with $\mathbb{D} = \mathbb{Z}[1/2]$ and $\omega = e^{i\pi/4}$. Qudit circuit families use other rings.

Each formalization ends with one of these records. For example, Statement (1) states that the real stabilizer relations [43] present the subgroup generated by their gates, while Statement (2) states that the Hadamard-Π relations [26] present the specified orthogonal group. The fields in Statements (3) and (4) state the two directions: equal matrices imply a derivable circuit equation, and every derivable equation preserves the matrix.

```
presentation : ∀ n → (n CRel,_===_) IsSubPresentationOf U (2 ^ n)          (1)
presentation : ∀ n → (n MRel,_===_) IsPresentationOf (O n)                 (2)
complete : ∀ {n} {w v : Circuit n} → [[ w ]] ≈ᵁ [[ v ]] → ⊢ w ≈ v          (3)
sound : ∀ {n} {w v : Circuit n} → ⊢ w ≈ v → [[ w ]] ≈ᵁ [[ v ]]             (4)
```

The minimality statement in Statement (5) says that the rule set is complete on n wires and becomes incomplete there if any rule is removed [14].

```
minimal-complete : ∀ {n} → (n ⊢_===_) IsMinimal × (n ⊢_===_) IsComplete     (5)
```

For each presentation, a reader checks four components against the source paper: the transcribed relations, the target group, the matrix of each gate, and the assignment of $[\![-]\!]$ to the record. Each Agda development collects these components and its main theorem in a MainTheorem module. The file `MainTheorems.agda` restates the results; the corresponding Lean statements are in `QCert/Table1.lean`.

Extensions of the earlier framework. Besides matrix semantics and minimality, QCert extends the one- and two-wire syntax of Bian and Feng [7] with three-wire gates such as Toffoli and explicit scalar generators for expressing exact equality, including global phase. It also supplies the structural swap laws of PROPs [41], so each paper need only state its own relations. Appendix D gives the encoding conventions, theorem notation, and implementation details.

3.1 Formalization Workflow

Our workflow has three parts. First, before formalizing a paper, we check its rewrite rules, its intermediate results, and each line of its derivations with exact matrices in short scripts. This caught most typos before any Agda code was written. Second, we state each main theorem in QCert before a coding agent starts, so the agent only supplies the proof. Finally, for long derivations, the agent writes a script that turns each line of the paper into one step of the Agda proof, so a failing step points to a specific line of the paper.

Direct evaluation of long matrix products was expensive, so QCert uses a shared exact procedure for matrix equality. We record this technique in the agents' instructions so that later formalizations reuse it; Appendix D.3 gives the implementation.

3.2 Avoiding Completeness Lost in Translation

Three design choices make the connection between each source claim and its formal statement explicit.

Independent semantics. The target group is defined independently of the circuit syntax, using matrices or an algebraic construction. Completeness therefore relates circuit equations to a separately defined semantics, as the case study in Section 4 illustrates.

Repaired statements. When a source rule set must be changed, the formal theorem names the revised set. This distinguishes a repair to the proof from a correction to the theorem itself (Section 6).

Checked reuse. QCert verifies general completeness arguments and group constructions once, including Reidemeister–Schreier coset enumeration [42] and presentations of semidirect products. Each application proves the required hypotheses and checks the connection to its circuit semantics.

3.3 Comparison of the Agda and Lean Formalizations

The Lean [24] version formalizes the same sixteen results using Mathlib's standard definitions [55], with matrix groups over real or complex numbers. It translates the Agda framework, so agreement between the two does not independently validate their shared design. Figure 5 compares proof size, verification time, and execution time. Lean developments generally use fewer lines and Agda records lower verification times in thirteen rows, but proofs and measurement methods differ; translating the same Toffoli–Hadamard proof yields similar amounts of text. Agda provides executable normal forms, whereas Lean's are existence results or `noncomputable` definitions. Panel (c) measures their executable circuit-equivalence procedures, where Lean is faster from three qubits onward. Appendix A gives the detailed comparison and measurement methods, summarized in Table 2.

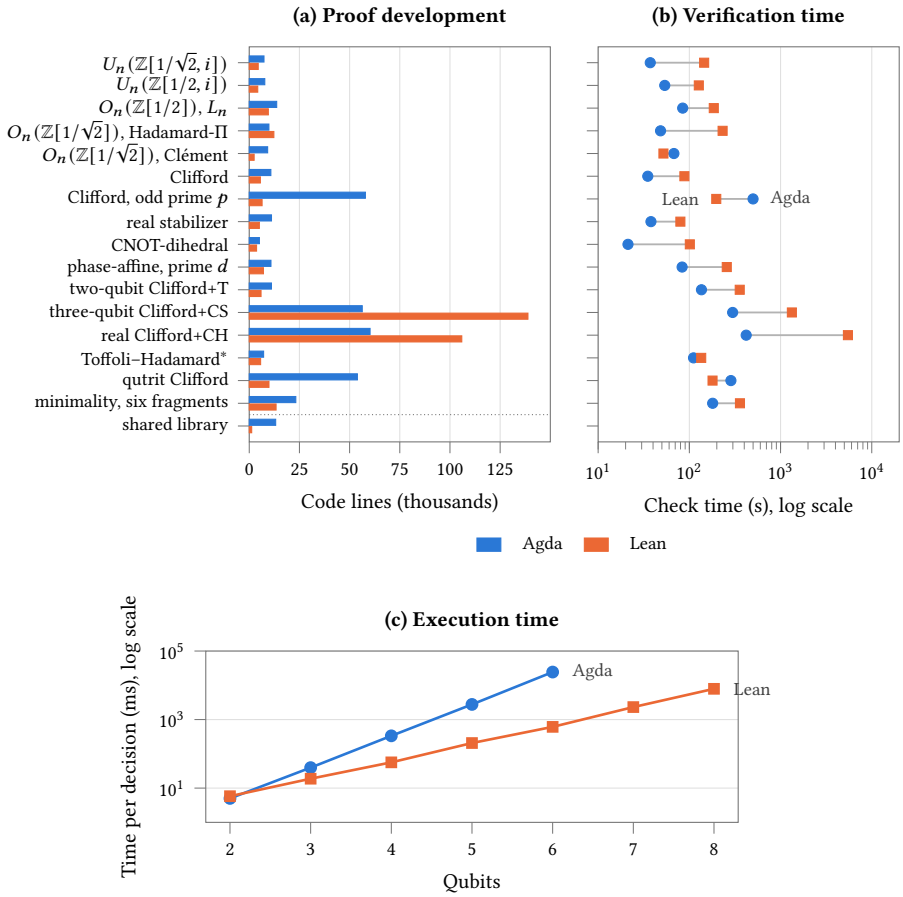


Fig. 5. The Agda and Lean formalizations of each row of Table 1. (a) Code lines, excluding blank lines and comments. For Toffoli–Hadamard* it shows another pair, one proof in both assistants (Appendix A): a second Agda proof and its translation to Lean. The last row is the shared library of each framework. (b) The check times of Table 1, Agda (circles) and Lean (squares), measured on the same machine, with methods described in Appendix A. (c) The time each compiled formalization takes to decide that two Clifford circuits of 100 gates have the same matrix, by the procedure its soundness proof uses, as medians over three runs of five random circuits.

4 Case Study: Multi-Qupit Clifford Completeness

The multi-qupit Clifford result of Bian, Li et al. [8] shows how QCert turns a circuit completeness proof into reusable, checked components. Here each qupit has odd prime dimension p; the result covers every number n of qupits and every such p. Its sixteen rules must derive every valid equation between Clifford circuits. Two choices matter for the rest of the paper: defining the semantic group independently of the circuit syntax, and assembling completeness proofs using general theorems about groups. We explain these choices here; Appendix B gives the definitions, formal statements, and derivations.

4.1 From Circuit Equations to Checked Derivations

The circuits use the Fourier gate H, the phase gate S, and the controlled-phase gate CZ. We first work projectively, identifying operators that differ only by a global phase. Figure 6 gives a small example of the translation into QCert: a swap is a word in the generators, its laws are circuit equations, and a derived equality records the rule used at each step. The framework supplies the structural rules that let the same derivation apply inside a larger circuit. The corresponding Agda definitions and proof terms are in Appendix B.1.

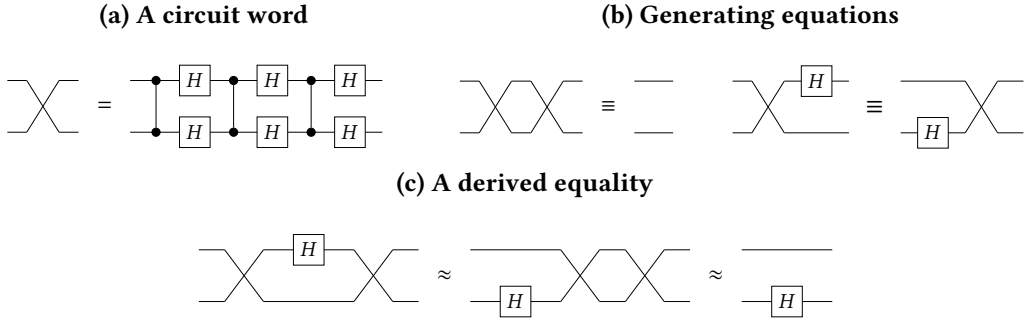


Fig. 6. Circuit syntax, rules, and reasoning in the projective Clifford formalization. Crossed wires denote swap, and connected dots denote CZ. Diagrams are read from right to left. In (c), moving H across one swap and cancelling the two swaps moves H to the other wire. The generating equations (≡) justify the derived equivalence (≈).

To prove completeness, we must also specify what a circuit means. We first consider its action on Pauli operators, ignoring phase factors. Each wire contributes a pair (a, b) modulo p, describing $X^a Z^b$ for the generalized Pauli shift and phase gates X and Z. The induced transformations form the symplectic group $\mathrm{Sp}(2n, \mathbb{Z}_p)$, which preserves Pauli commutation. This first stage identifies Clifford operators that differ by a Pauli; the next stage restores that information. This group is defined using linear algebra, independently of circuits and their rewrite rules. Completeness at this stage therefore requires a proof that equal transformations give derivable equations in the symplectic theory.

4.2 Normalize the Factors, Then Compose

The first step is a normal-form proof for this symplectic group. Figure 7 shows the recursive shape: a canonical block accounts for one wire, and normalization continues on the remaining wires. The formalization proves that every circuit rewrites to this shape, that each rewrite preserves its meaning, and that the normal form is uniquely determined by that meaning. Consequently, circuits denoting the same transformation rewrite to the same normal form and are equivalent. This is the normalization strategy of Section 2, instantiated with the source paper's circuit blocks; the datatypes and normalization table are in Appendix B.2.

Symplectic transformations retain only the Clifford action modulo Paulis. To restore the Paulis, we present their phase space $V = \mathbb{Z}_p^{2n}$ separately and combine the two presentations into the independently defined model $V \rtimes \mathrm{Sp}(2n, \mathbb{Z}_p)$. The semidirect product records how a symplectic transformation acts on Pauli exponents. QCert's general composition theorem asks us to prove that this action respects the relations of both factors. Once these obligations are checked, completeness of the combined presentation follows from completeness of the factors.

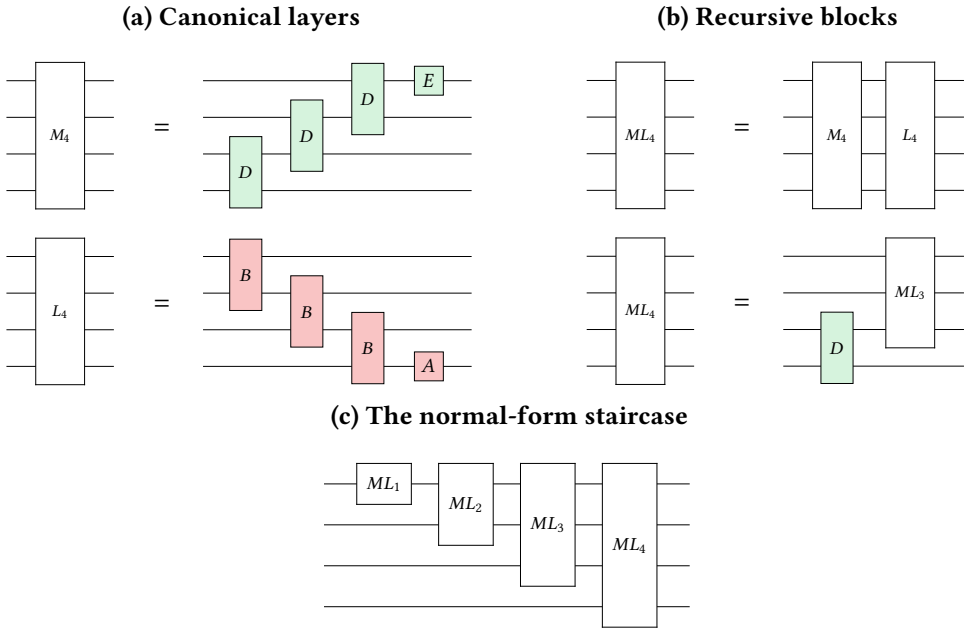


Fig. 7. The symplectic normal form, illustrated on four wires. (a) The M and L layers use the source paper's parameterized circuit blocks A, B, D, and E. (b) An ML block combines the two layers or extends a smaller ML block by a D block. (c) One block per width gives the staircase. Its uniqueness is the key completeness obligation; Paulis and scalar phases are restored separately.

This replaces the most difficult part of following the source proof directly. Its passage from symplectic to projective completeness tracks a Pauli correction through each rewrite. We instead discharge the compatibility obligations once and use the framework's semidirect-product theorem. Verified translations then recover the paper's generators and relations. Finally, the scalar-extension theorem restores global phases, with the necessary phase corrections checked explicitly (Figure 8). The construction-specific calculations remain in the case study; the composition theorems can be reused by other developments.

4.3 What the Formalization Establishes

Agda checks the presentations of the symplectic, projective, and scalar-extension models for every odd prime p and every width n, with no postulates or unfinished proofs. In particular, it checks both normalization and the translations back to the source rule sets. This demonstrates how QCert can support a proof that needs substantial mathematical restructuring while keeping each obligation explicit.

The semantic boundary is also explicit. The Agda development presents independently constructed algebraic models; identifying them with the unitary Clifford groups and matching the paper's gate phases uses external mathematics. The Lean development proves soundness and completeness directly against complex matrices (Appendix A). Appendix B records the Agda theorem statements, the external identification argument, and the implementation details. Thus the case study shows both how the proof is assembled and exactly which connection each proof assistant checks.

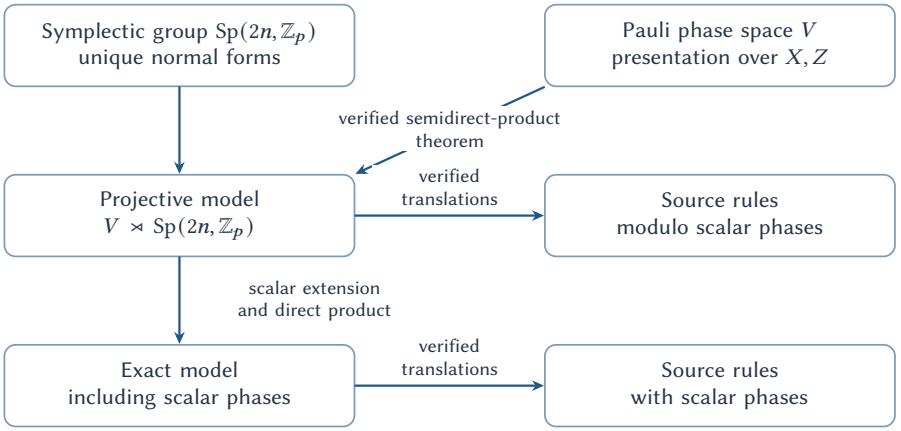


Fig. 8. The proof is assembled from verified components. The symplectic normal-form proof and the Pauli presentation combine into a projective model; restoring phases gives an exact model. Arrows denote checked constructions and translations of presentations. Appendix B.3 gives the intermediate rule sets, and Appendix B.4 gives the scalar corrections.

5 Formalized Completeness and Minimality Proofs

The sixteen formalizations in Table 1 contain about 377,000 lines of Agda code and use no postulates, and each theorem is as general as the result in its source paper. Moreover, all matrices are computed exactly. Their entries lie in algebraic number rings, whose elements are given by finitely many integers, so Agda checks automatically whether two matrices are equal. Over the real or complex numbers, no such automatic check exists, which limits the equality checking of QCert to discrete gate sets, as we discuss in Section 7.

Figure 9 adds completeness status to the families and inclusions of Figure 2, using the survey's notation [49]. It separates circuit relations from presentations of the underlying matrix groups. QCert covers the integral, scaled-real, Gaussian, and real matrix presentations, but circuit completeness for Clifford+T and Clifford+CS is still restricted to small widths. A presentation of the ambient matrix group does not by itself provide relations for every circuit subgroup.

The green checks in Figure 9 correspond to the qubit part of Table 1; the qudit results and minimality proofs are also listed in the table. The asterisks connect this coverage to the source corrections in Section 6.

Two qualifications apply to the Agda results in Table 1. The two-qubit Clifford+T and three-qubit Clifford+CS developments [10, 11] reuse the authors' Agda proofs and connect them to QCert's shared matrix presentations (Section 3). The qudit Clifford theorem of Bian, Li et al. [8] presents an independently constructed algebraic model; Section 4 explains its connection to the intended unitary semantics.

6 Corrections to the Source Papers

The formalizations in Table 1 identify two kinds of issues in the source papers. Most are typos, and some of them appear in statements that the proofs rely on. These are easy to fix. Two others are harder to repair. One is a gap in a proof, and the other is a relation missing from a theorem. We describe both below.

The gap is in the proof of Theorem 4.14 of Hadamard-Π [26], which states that the relations in its Figure 6, over the one- and two-level matrices $(-1)_{[a]}$, $\mathrm{X}_{[a,b]}$, and $\mathrm{H}_{[a,b]}$, present the group

Source	Object	Result	Agda Mod	Agda time (s)	Lean time (s)
Groups of m-level matrices					
Greylyn [2014]	$U_n(\mathbb{Z}[1/\sqrt{2}, i])$	presentation, $n \leq 4$	34	37.28	145.34
Bian and Selinger [2021]	$U_n(\mathbb{Z}[1/2, i])$	presentation	39	53.73	126.99
Li et al. [2021]	$O_n(\mathbb{Z}[1/2])$, L_n	presentations	71	84.52	185.32
Fang et al. [2026]	$O_n(\mathbb{Z}[1/\sqrt{2}])$	presentation	46	48.33	231.57
Clément [2019]	$O_n(\mathbb{Z}[1/\sqrt{2}])$	presentation	43	67.72	51.99
Circuits					
Selinger [2015]	Clifford	sub-presentation	32	35.01	88.24
Bian, Li et al. [2026]	Clifford, odd prime p	presentation of a model	216	499.37	197.32
Makary et al. [2021]	real stabilizer	sub-presentation	31	37.94	79.75
Amy et al. [2018]	CNOT-dihedral	sub-presentation	31	21.24	101.22
Blake [2026b]	phase-affine, prime d	sub-presentations	57	83.30	257.24
Bian and Selinger [2023a]	two-qubit Clifford+T	sub-presentation in U_4	63	135.79	356.79
Bian and Selinger [2023b]	three-qubit Clifford+CS	sub-presentation in U_8	125	298.29	1330.89
Clément [2026]	real Clifford+CH	sub-presentation	348	419.99	5478.79*
Amy et al. [2024]	three-qubit Toffoli–Hadamard	presentation of L_8	203	111.17	134.91
Li et al. [2025]	qutrit Clifford	presentation	90	285.58	179.60
Minimality					
Blake [2026c]	six fragments	minimal, complete	80	180.10	358.87
Total			1,509	2,399.36	9,304.83

Table 1. Completeness and minimality results formalized in QCert. A presentation gives generators and relations for a whole group, and a sub-presentation for the subgroup generated by the gate set named in the Object column of the Circuits block. L_n is the group of orthogonal matrices $N/\sqrt{2}^j$, where N is an integer matrix and $j \geq 0$. Mod counts Agda modules. The Agda times are typechecking times from scratch with Agda 2.8, the times its profiler reports for the row's modules; the Lean times are elapsed folder-build times. Both were measured on the same machine, under the conditions in Appendix A. Both columns exclude the shared library and other developments on which a row depends. The Result column describes the Agda statements; Appendix A explains the semantic differences. * Includes two unused legacy helpers that failed; the main theorem chain passed.

$O_n\left(\mathbb{Z}\left[1/\sqrt{2}\right]\right)$. One case of the proof relies on Lemmas A.16 and A.17, which have counterexamples in dimension 6, and the case analysis built on them misses a matrix in dimension 9. Their main result is however still correct: Clément's unpublished notes [19] present the same group with different relations, and his case analysis covers the missing case, using which the formalization of Theorem 4.14 is completed. We also prove that the two sets of relations are equivalent in every dimension and formalize Clément's proof [4].

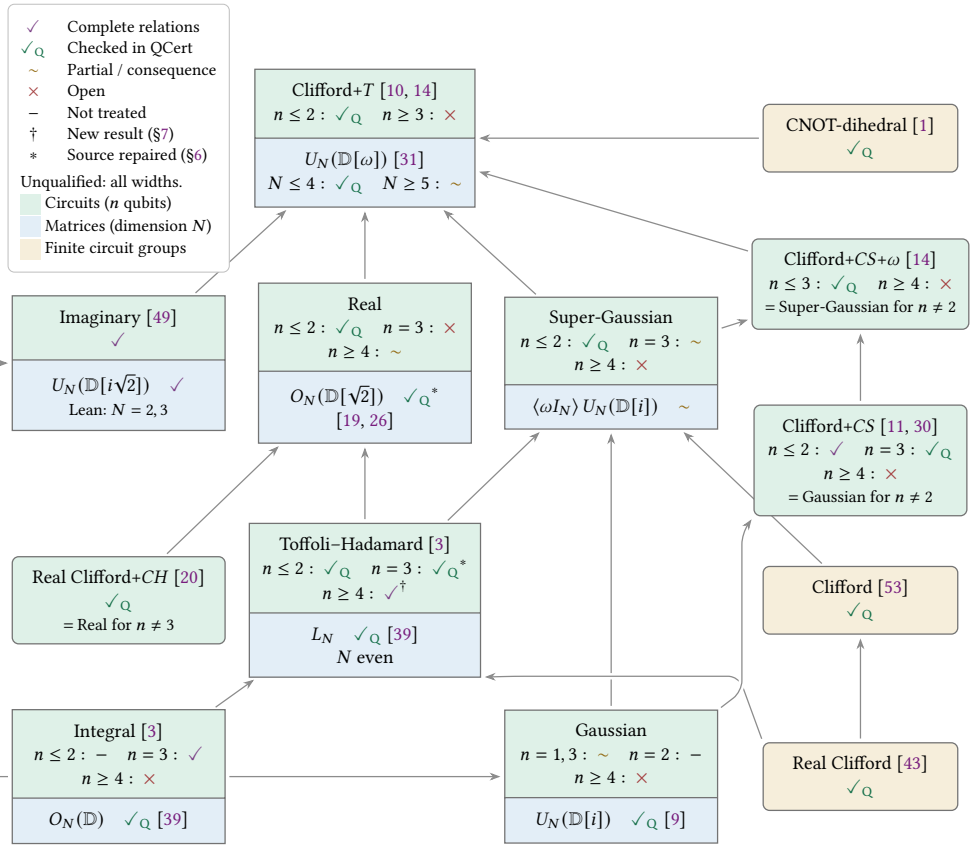


Fig. 9. Completeness progress on the same families and inclusion arrows as Figure 2. The dagger marks the new Toffoli–Hadamard result, whose exposition is in preparation. Gates and multi-level generators are omitted; upper compartments concern ancilla-free circuits, lower compartments matrix presentations. Here n counts qubits and N is matrix dimension ($N = 2^n$ for a circuit). The survey's ~ includes consequences whose gate-set transfer is not formalized in the corpus; a plain check does not assert QCert verification. Imaginary-family checks refer to new computer-assisted proofs [49]; their complete Lean checks cover only $N = 2, 3$ and are outside this corpus. The higher-dimensional Clifford+T matrix presentation remains incomplete. L_N is defined in Table 1; the other notation is as in Figure 2.

The relation is missing from Theorem 5.2 of [3]. It states that the relations in its Figures 4 and 7, over the Toffoli and $\mathrm{K} = \mathrm{H} \otimes \mathrm{H}$ gates, present the group $O_8(\mathbb{Z}[1/2])$. This is the first of two steps towards presenting the scaled dyadic orthogonal group L_8 by three-qubit Toffoli–Hadamard circuits. The relation r_K in its Section 5.5, which splits K on two qubits into two copies controlled by the third qubit, is in neither figure. Nor can it be derived from them. Hence, Theorem 5.2 fails as stated. Our formalization [5] shows that r_K is independent by giving an interpretation of circuits that every other relation preserves but r_K does not, and proves the presentations of $O_8(\mathbb{Z}[1/2])$ and L_8 with r_K restored.

7 Discussion and Future Work

We formalize the results of sixteen papers in QCert, using consistent circuit syntax, a unified definition of group presentations, and shared libraries for rings and their matrix groups. Since all formalizations use these definitions, presentations of the same group from different papers can be compared and proved equivalent. The same libraries can be reused for new algorithms, and the induction that turns an exact synthesis algorithm into a completeness proof carries over with little change. The main part specific to each algorithm is the case analysis over matrices and generators. As the most error-prone part of the proof, it is where machine checking in QCert matters most.

Reusing this infrastructure, we have obtained complete equational theories for circuits over $\{X, CX, CCX\}$ and for Toffoli–Hadamard circuits. We are now preparing mathematical expositions of these results.

At the moment, not every completeness result fits into QCert, as its scope is limited in two ways. First, it supports only discrete gate sets, so it does not cover completeness results for circuits with continuous parameters, such as rotations by arbitrary angles [21–23]. Second, control is not a circuit constructor in QCert, so it does not cover results that treat control as a primitive operation on circuits [12, 25, 52].

We plan to extend the infrastructure of QCert to more families of quantum circuits, including the two above. Completeness is still open for many discrete gate sets in higher-dimensional quantum systems, and their case analyses are often too large to check by hand. In particular, we plan to study the completeness of Clifford circuits in all dimensions with the help of QCert. Beyond completeness, the exact synthesis libraries can be reused for T-count optimization of multi-qubit Clifford+T circuits.

References

[1] Matthew Amy, Jianxin Chen, and Neil J. Ross. 2018. A finite presentation of CNOT-dihedral operators. In *Proceedings of the 14th International Conference on Quantum Physics and Logic (QPL 2017) (Electronic Proceedings in Theoretical Computer Science, Vol. 266)*. 84–97. doi:10.4204/EPTCS.266.5

[2] Matthew Amy, Andrew N. Glaudell, and Neil J. Ross. 2020. Number-theoretic characterizations of some restricted Clifford+T circuits. *Quantum* 4 (2020), 252.

[3] Matthew Amy, Neil J. Ross, and Scott Wesley. 2024. A sound and complete equational theory for 3-qubit Toffoli-Hadamard circuits. In *Proceedings of the 21st International Conference on Quantum Physics and Logic (QPL 2024) (Electronic Proceedings in Theoretical Computer Science, Vol. 406)*. 1–43. doi:10.4204/EPTCS.406.1 arXiv:2407.11152

[4] Anonymous. 2026. QCert: The presentations of $O_n(\mathbb{Z}[1/\sqrt{2}])$ by Hadamard-Π and by Clément, formalized in Agda. Supplementary material, modules `Real-Clifford+CH-TwoLevel/Equivalence` (the equivalence of the two sets of relations) and `Real-Clifford+CH-TwoLevel-Clement` (Clément's proof and its decision trees).

[5] Anonymous. 2026. QCert: Three-qubit Toffoli–Hadamard circuits with the relation r_{K}, formalized in Agda. Supplementary material, modules `CCX+H-3qubit-RS/Theorems` (the presentations of $O_8(\mathbb{Z}[1/2])$ and L_8) and `CCX+H-3qubit-RS/Independence` (the interpretation showing that r_{K} is not derivable).

[6] Alexander Bastounis, Fabian Circelli, and Anders C. Hansen. 2026. Navier-Stokes lost in translation: Why Lean verification of AI autoformalisation does not guarantee correct natural language proofs. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2610.08144* (2026).

[7] Xiaoning Bian and Yuan Feng. 2027. Normal forms and complete relations for circuits in Agda. *Proceedings of the ACM on Programming Languages* POPL (2027). To appear.

[8] Xiaoning Bian, Sarah Meng Li, Neil J. Ross, John van de Wetering, and Yuming Zhao. 2026. A complete and natural rule set for multi-qudit Clifford circuits in all odd prime dimensions. arXiv:2609.40106

[9] Xiaoning Bian and Peter Selinger. 2021. Generators and relations for $U_n(\mathbb{Z}[1/2, i])$. In *Proceedings of the 18th International Conference on Quantum Physics and Logic (QPL 2021) (Electronic Proceedings in Theoretical Computer Science, Vol. 343)*. 145–164. doi:10.4204/EPTCS.343.8 arXiv:2105.14047

[10] Xiaoning Bian and Peter Selinger. 2023. Generators and relations for 2-qubit Clifford+T operators. In *Proceedings of the 19th International Conference on Quantum Physics and Logic (QPL 2022) (Electronic Proceedings in Theoretical Computer Science, Vol. 394)*. 13–28. doi:10.4204/EPTCS.394.2 arXiv:2204.02217

[11] Xiaoning Bian and Peter Selinger. 2023. Generators and relations for 3-qubit Clifford+CS operators. In *Proceedings of the 20th International Conference on Quantum Physics and Logic (QPL 2023) (Electronic Proceedings in Theoretical Computer Science, Vol. 384)*. 114–126. doi:10.4204/EPTCS.384.7 arXiv:2306.08530

[12] Colin Blake. 2026. A complete equational presentation of qudit circuits via polycontrolled PROPs. In *Proceedings of the 51st International Symposium on Mathematical Foundations of Computer Science (MFCS 2026) (Leibniz International Proceedings in Informatics, Vol. 386)*. Schloss Dagstuhl – Leibniz-Zentrum für Informatik, Dagstuhl, Germany, 6:1–6:18. doi:10.4230/LIPIcs.MFCS.2026.6 arXiv:2602.09873

[13] Colin Blake. 2026. Completeness for prime-dimensional phase-affine circuits. arXiv:2603.06466

[14] Colin Blake. 2026. Simpler presentations for many fragments of quantum circuits. In *Proceedings of the 11th International Conference on Formal Structures for Computation and Deduction (FSCD 2026) (Leibniz International Proceedings in Informatics, Vol. 378)*. 6:1–6:20. doi:10.4230/LIPIcs.FSCD.2026.6 arXiv:2602.09874

[15] Ana Bove, Peter Dybjer, and Ulf Norell. 2009. A brief overview of Agda – a functional language with dependent types. In *Theorem Proving in Higher Order Logics (TPHOLs 2009) (Lecture Notes in Computer Science, Vol. 5674)*. Springer, Berlin, Heidelberg, 73–78.

[16] Jacques Carette, Chris Heunen, Robin Kaarsgaard, and Amr Sabry. 2024. With a few square roots, quantum computing is as easy as Π. *Proceedings of the ACM on Programming Languages* 8, POPL (2024). arXiv:2310.14056

[17] Christophe Chareton, Sébastien Bardin, François Bobot, Valentin Perrelle, and Benoît Valiron. 2021. An automated deductive verification framework for circuit-building quantum programs. In *Programming Languages and Systems: 30th European Symposium on Programming (ESOP 2021) (Lecture Notes in Computer Science, Vol. 12648)*. 148–177.

[18] Vikraman Choudhury, Jacek Karwowski, and Amr Sabry. 2022. Symmetries in reversible programming: From symmetric rig groupoids to reversible programming languages. *Proceedings of the ACM on Programming Languages* 6, POPL, Article 6 (2022), 32 pages.

[19] Alexandre Clément. 2019. A complete set of relations for the real Clifford+T group. Unfinished manuscript. https://www.mathstat.dal.ca/~aclement/Case%20distinction.pdf

[20] Alexandre Clément. 2026. A complete equational theory for real-Clifford+CH quantum circuits. arXiv:2602.06644

[21] Alexandre Clément, Noé Delorme, and Simon Perdrix. 2024. Minimal equational theories for quantum circuits. In *Proceedings of the 39th Annual ACM/IEEE Symposium on Logic in Computer Science (LICS 2024)*. 27:1–27:14. doi:10.1145/3661814.3662088 arXiv:2311.07476

[22] Alexandre Clément, Noé Delorme, Simon Perdrix, and Renaud Vilmart. 2024. Quantum circuit completeness: Extensions and simplifications. In *Proceedings of the 32nd EACSL Annual Conference on Computer Science Logic (CSL 2024) (Leibniz International Proceedings in Informatics, Vol. 288)*. Schloss Dagstuhl – Leibniz-Zentrum für Informatik, Dagstuhl, Germany, 20:1–20:23. doi:10.4230/LIPIcs.CSL.2024.20 arXiv:2303.03117

[23] Alexandre Clément, Nicolas Heurtel, Shane Mansfield, Simon Perdrix, and Benoît Valiron. 2023. A complete equational theory for quantum circuits. In *Proceedings of the 38th Annual ACM/IEEE Symposium on Logic in Computer Science (LICS 2023)*. 1–13. doi:10.1109/LICS56636.2023.10175801 arXiv:2206.10577

[24] Leonardo de Moura and Sebastian Ullrich. 2021. The Lean 4 theorem prover and programming language. In *Automated Deduction – CADE 28 (Lecture Notes in Computer Science, Vol. 12699)*. Springer, 625–635. doi:10.1007/978-3-030-79876-5_37

[25] Noé Delorme and Simon Perdrix. 2026. Diagrammatic reasoning with control as a constructor, applications to quantum circuits. In *Foundations of Software Science and Computation Structures (FoSSaCS 2026) (Lecture Notes in Computer Science, Vol. 16503)*. Springer Nature Switzerland, Cham, Switzerland, 240–261. doi:10.1007/978-3-032-22730-0_12 arXiv:2508.21756

[26] Wang Fang, Chris Heunen, and Robin Kaarsgaard. 2026. Hadamard-Π: Equational quantum programming. *Proceedings of the ACM on Programming Languages* 10, POPL, Article 5 (2026), 27 pages. doi:10.1145/3776647 arXiv:2506.06835

[27] Shiguang Feng and Lvzhou Li. 2026. A complete set of transformation rules for reversible circuits. *IEEE Transactions on Computer-Aided Design of Integrated Circuits and Systems* 45, 8 (2026), 3711–3724. doi:10.1109/TCAD.2025.3641533 arXiv:2508.17273

[28] Shiguang Feng, Zongxing Xiong, and Lvzhou Li. 2026. On the completeness of transformation rules in reversible logic synthesis. arXiv:2607.19059

[29] Brett Giles and Peter Selinger. 2013. Exact synthesis of multiqubit Clifford+T circuits. *Physical Review A* 87 (2013), 032332. arXiv:1212.0506

[30] Andrew N. Glaudell, Neil J. Ross, and Jacob M. Taylor. 2021. Optimal two-qubit circuits for universal fault-tolerant quantum computation. *npj Quantum Information* 7 (2021), 103. doi:10.1038/s41534-021-00424-z arXiv:2001.05997

[31] Seth Eveson Murray Greylyn. 2014. *Generators and relations for the group* $U_4(\mathbb{Z}[1/\sqrt{2}, i])$. MSc thesis. Dalhousie University. arXiv:1408.6204

[32] David Gross. 2006. Hudson's theorem for finite-dimensional quantum systems. *J. Math. Phys.* 47, 12 (2006), 122107. doi:10.1063/1.2393152

[33] Shamgar Gurevich and Ronny Hadani. 2007. The geometric Weil representation. *Selecta Mathematica* 13 (2007), 465–481. doi:10.1007/s00029-007-0047-3

[34] Shamgar Gurevich and Ronny Hadani. 2010. Bounds on certain higher-dimensional exponential sums via the self-reducibility of the Weil representation. arXiv:math/0612765 [math.RT] https://arxiv.org/abs/math/0612765

[35] Thomas Hales. 2026. What mathematicians should know about the Lean theorem prover: Questions of reliability and AI. Guest post on Terence Tao's blog *What's new*. https://terrytao.wordpress.com/2026/10/09/what-mathematicians-should-know-about-the-lean-theorem-proverquestions-of-reliability-and-ai/ 9 October 2026.

[36] Kesha Hietala, Robert Rand, Shih-Han Hung, Xiaodi Wu, and Michael Hicks. 2021. A verified optimizer for quantum circuits. *Proceedings of the ACM on Programming Languages* 5, POPL, Article 37 (2021), 29 pages. doi:10.1145/3434318

[37] Yves Lafont. 2003. Towards an algebraic theory of Boolean circuits. *Journal of Pure and Applied Algebra* 184, 2–3 (2003), 257–310. doi:10.1016/S0022-4049(03)00069-0

[38] Sarah Meng Li, Michele Mosca, Neil J. Ross, John van de Wetering, and Yuming Zhao. 2025. A complete and natural rule set for multi-qutrit Clifford circuits. In *Proceedings of the 22nd International Conference on Quantum Physics and Logic (QPL 2025) (Electronic Proceedings in Theoretical Computer Science, Vol. 426)*. 23–78. doi:10.4204/EPTCS.426.2 arXiv:2508.14670

[39] Sarah Meng Li, Neil J. Ross, and Peter Selinger. 2021. Generators and relations for the group $O_n(\mathbb{Z}[1/2])$. In *Proceedings of the 18th International Conference on Quantum Physics and Logic (QPL 2021) (Electronic Proceedings in Theoretical Computer Science, Vol. 343)*. 210–264. doi:10.4204/EPTCS.343.11 arXiv:2106.01175

[40] Sirui Lu, Ruixuan Deng, Yanqiao Zhu, and Zhengfeng Ji. 2026. Long-horizon autoformalization of a core theorem underlying MIP* = RE. doi:10.48550/arXiv.2609.19814 arXiv:2609.19814 [quant-ph]

[41] Saunders Mac Lane. 1965. Categorical algebra. *Bull. Amer. Math. Soc.* 71, 1 (1965), 40–106. doi:10.1090/S0002-9904-1965-11234-4

[42] Wilhelm Magnus, Abraham Karrass, and Donald Solitar. 2004. *Combinatorial group theory: Presentations of groups in terms of generators and relations* (2nd revised ed.). Dover Publications.

[43] Justin Makary, Neil J. Ross, and Peter Selinger. 2021. Generators and relations for real stabilizer operators. In *Proceedings of the 18th International Conference on Quantum Physics and Logic (QPL 2021) (Electronic Proceedings in Theoretical Computer Science, Vol. 343)*. 14–36. doi:10.4204/EPTCS.343.2 arXiv:2109.05655

[44] Dmitri Maslov, Gerhard W. Dueck, D. Michael Miller, and Camille Negrevergne. 2008. Quantum circuit simplification and level compaction. *IEEE Transactions on Computer-Aided Design of Integrated Circuits and Systems* 27, 3 (2008), 436–444. doi:10.1109/TCAD.2007.911334

[45] Yunseong Nam, Neil J. Ross, Yuan Su, Andrew M. Childs, and Dmitri Maslov. 2018. Automated optimization of large quantum circuits with continuous parameters. *npj Quantum Information* 4 (2018), 23. doi:10.1038/s41534-018-0072-4

[46] Markus Neuhauser. 2002. An Explicit Construction of the Metaplectic Representation over a Finite Field. *Journal of Lie Theory* 12, 1 (2002), 15–30. doi:10.5802/jolt.250

[47] Ulf Norell. 2007. *Towards a practical programming language based on dependent type theory*. Ph. D. Dissertation. Chalmers University of Technology.

[48] Jennifer Paykin, Robert Rand, and Steve Zdancewic. 2017. QWIRE: A core language for quantum circuits. In *Proceedings of the 44th ACM SIGPLAN Symposium on Principles of Programming Languages (POPL 2017)*. 846–858.

[49] RelationsStatus 2026. Complete relations for restricted Clifford+T operators: status by exact synthesis algorithm. Unpublished working notes. Version of 7 November 2026.

[50] Yuanjie (Collin) Ren, Zhicheng Zhang, Junyi Liu, Jinzheng Li, Yidi Qi, and Mingsheng Ying. 2026. QEDIA: Quantum program verification in Lean. doi:10.48550/arXiv.2610.17708 arXiv:2610.17708 [quant-ph]

[51] Issei Sakashita. 2013. A complete transformation rule set and a minimal equation set for CNOT-based 3-qubit quantum circuits (Draft). arXiv:1304.5916

[52] William Schober and Scott Wesley. 2026. A complete equational theory for quantum circuits with generalized control. https://cqi.inf.usi.ch/publications/Hierarchical_QPL2026.pdf Accepted to the proceedings track of the 23rd International Conference on Quantum Physics and Logic (QPL 2026).

[53] Peter Selinger. 2015. Generators and relations for n-qubit Clifford operators. *Logical Methods in Computer Science* 11, 2:10 (2015). doi:10.2168/LMCS-11(2:10)2015 arXiv:1310.6813

[54] Seyon Sivarajah, Silas Dilkes, Alexander Cowtan, Will Simmons, Alec Edgington, and Ross Duncan. 2020. t|ket⟩: A retargetable compiler for NISQ devices. *Quantum Science and Technology* 6, 1 (2020), 014003. doi:10.1088/2058-9565/ab8e92

[55] The mathlib Community. 2020. The Lean mathematical library. In *Proceedings of the 9th ACM SIGPLAN International Conference on Certified Programs and Proofs (CPP 2020)*. 367–381. doi:10.1145/3372885.3373824

[56] Mingkuan Xu, Zikun Li, Oded Padon, Sina Lin, Jessica Pointing, Auguste Hirth, Henry Ma, Jens Palsberg, Alex Aiken, Umut A. Acar, and Zhihao Jia. 2022. Quartz: Superoptimization of quantum circuits. In *Proceedings of the 43rd ACM SIGPLAN International Conference on Programming Language Design and Implementation (PLDI 2022)*. Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 625–640. doi:10.1145/3519939.3523433

[57] Shigeru Yamashita and Igor L. Markov. 2010. Fast equivalence-checking for quantum circuits. *Quantum Information and Computation* 10, 9–10 (2010), 721–734. doi:10.26421/QIC10.9-10-1

[58] Lei Zhang, Mingrui Jing, Yusheng Zhao, Jiahong Liu, and Xin Wang. 2026. Lean-QuantumAlg: A framework for AI agents to produce quantum algorithms that humans can trust. doi:10.48550/arXiv.2610.30216 arXiv:2610.30216 [quant-ph]

[59] Li Zhou, Gilles Barthe, Pierre-Yves Strub, Junyi Liu, and Mingsheng Ying. 2023. CoqQ: Foundational verification of quantum programs. *Proceedings of the ACM on Programming Languages* 7, POPL, Article 29 (2023), 33 pages.

A Agda and Lean Comparison

The Lean [24] version of QCert formalizes the same sixteen results on top of Mathlib [55]. Once the Agda formalization exists, translating it to Lean is comparatively easy, so the Lean version is not a second achievement of the same kind. Its point is its theorem statements. They rest on Mathlib's standard definitions, with matrix groups over Mathlib's real or complex numbers in place of our exact rings, so a reader can check them against the source papers using definitions that are already widely used and reviewed. For qudit Clifford, the Lean statement also removes an argument that the Agda statement leaves to external mathematics (Section 4.3).

Nor is the Lean framework an independent implementation. We instructed the coding agent that wrote it not to consult our Agda implementation, but the Lean framework is nonetheless a translation of the Agda one. Its words, circuit generators, structural rules, and presentation and sub-presentation predicates are those of the Agda framework, down to the names of the definitions and the wording of their documentation. The two formalizations therefore share the design of their framework, and would share any mistake in it, so their agreement is weaker evidence than two independent formalizations would give. They use different representations and sometimes different proofs, so the theorem statements of each must be checked against the source papers separately. We compare their definitions, proof development, verification time, and execution time; Table 2 summarizes the comparison. These observations concern our two formalizations, not Agda and Lean in general.

Definitions and semantics. The translation keeps the definitions but adapts their representation to Mathlib. Agda uses its own word type, with explicit brackets, and the setoid-based algebra of the standard library. A presentation is a record containing a semantics and a group isomorphism, or a monomorphism for a sub-presentation. Lean uses Mathlib's free monoid and the monoid congruence generated by the relations. Its presentations are predicates in `Prop`, from which it derives isomorphisms out of the quotient. In both, the circuit infrastructure, the structural rules, and general completeness arguments are shared between developments.

The semantic targets also differ. Most Agda developments work directly with exact representations of matrix entries. Lean states its matrix groups over Mathlib's real or complex numbers and proves bridges to them from computable exact rings. In particular, the Agda qudit Clifford development presents the constructed model of Section 4, whereas Lean proves soundness and completeness against complex matrices for every odd prime. A common source therefore does not imply identical statements or intermediate lemmas.

Proof development. Excluding blank lines and comments, the Agda formalization of Table 1 has about 377,000 lines and the Lean formalization about 339,000 (Table 2). Figure 5(a) compares them row by row, except that for Toffoli–Hadamard it shows another pair, one proof in both assistants (see below). Lean's is shorter in thirteen of the sixteen rows, by a factor of five or more for qudit Clifford and qutrit Clifford, where the two take different routes. It is longer for Hadamard-Π, three-qubit Clifford+CS, and real Clifford+CH. Both counts include the derivations and certificates that scripts generate. The Agda proofs are explicit terms, built by pattern matching and equational reasoning, with reflection-based solvers for associativity and ring identities. Its library develops the group theory the proofs need, in about 13,200 lines against 1,200 in Lean. The Lean proofs rely on Mathlib's algebra and on tactics, with about 69,000 calls to automation such as `simp`, `omega`, `decide`, and `ring`.

Both implementations reuse normal-form, exact-synthesis, and translation arguments. Both also check generated derivations with a replay procedure that is proved correct. The proof assistant checks the computation and the theorem that a successful replay gives a derivation, so the scripts

	Agda	Lean
Proof development		
Logic	constructive: every module `--safe`, no postulates	classical: every main theorem uses `Classical.choice`
Library	standard library (104 modules imported), EucDomain	Mathlib (56 modules imported directly)
Proofs	terms, by pattern matching and equational reasoning; reflection-based solvers	tactics: about 75,000 tactic blocks, 69,000 automation calls
Reused from the sources	the authors' Agda proofs for Clifford+T and Clifford+CS	no proofs; the authors' coset-action data for Clifford+T
Modules	1,509	795
Code lines	376,627	338,866
Verification time		
Decided equalities	a Boolean reduced to `true`	`decide +kernel`
Check time, sixteen rows	2,399 s	9,305 s
Faster for	thirteen rows	three rows
Execution time		
Normal forms	executable functions	existence theorems or `noncomputable` definitions (460 declared)
Benchmarked procedure	matrix of each circuit, by products of stored matrices	simulation of each circuit on every basis vector
Compiled through	GHC (Haskell)	C
Per decision, Clifford, 100 gates	5.0 ms on 2 qubits, 24 s on 6	5.8 ms on 2 qubits, 0.61 s on 6

Table 2. The Agda and Lean formalizations compared. Counts are over the files under version control in the sixteen development folders of Table 1, without the shared libraries, and code lines exclude blank lines and comments. Check times are those of Table 1, and execution times those of Figure 5(c).

that search for derivations need not be trusted. For Clifford+CS, Lean constructs its own coset certificates. The trust checks reflect the different foundations. Every Agda module is `--safe` and uses no postulates, so the Agda corpus is constructive. The Lean corpus uses no `native_decide`, and its main theorems depend on no unfinished proof. An audit of 105 declarations reports only the axioms `propext`, `Classical.choice`, and `Quot.sound`.

Verification time. Table 1 and Figure 5(b) give the check times, both measured on the same machine. In total Agda took 2,399 seconds and Lean 9,305, or 1,979 and 3,826 without real Clifford+CH, whose Lean build alone took 5,479 seconds, more than half of the total. Lean took between 1.2 and 4.8 times as long as Agda on twelve rows, and 13 times as long on real Clifford+CH. Its five-wire certificate modules `Family267` and `Family268` alone took about 1,741 and 1,369 seconds. Lean was faster for three rows, Clément's presentation, qudit Clifford, and qutrit Clifford, whose Lean proofs

take different routes. Both assistants decide equalities of matrices and certificates by evaluation in the checker. Agda reduces a Boolean to `true`, and Lean uses `decide +kernel`.

Both columns were measured under WSL on an Intel Core i5-13400TEF with sixteen logical CPUs, about 26 GiB of RAM, and 64 GiB of swap. The Agda column comes from a check from scratch on 8 November 2026, with Agda 2.8.0 and version 2.4 of its standard library. We removed the repository's interface files, kept those of the standard library and EucDomain, and checked the shared library and then each row in an Agda process of its own, through a module that imports every module of the row. Agda's profiler reports the time spent on each module without its imports, and a row's time is the sum over its own modules, wherever they were checked. It leaves out process startup and the loading of interface files: the whole check, shared library included, took 3,210 seconds of wall time, and no process used more than 5.1 GiB. No other proof assistant ran during the check. The Lean column comes from a clean build on 5–6 November 2026, with Lean 4.30.0 and the pinned Mathlib revision. We removed QCert's build artifacts, kept the Mathlib and other dependency caches, and built the folders one at a time in dependency order with `LEAN_NUM_THREADS=2`. Each time is the elapsed wall time of a folder, including Lake startup and artifact generation, and a shared dependency is counted only in the folder that defines it. The two columns therefore measure different things, per-module checking time in Agda and folder build time in Lean. Proof constructions, module boundaries, parallelism, and artifact generation also differ, so the differences cannot be attributed to the proof assistants alone. We have yet to separate the time Lean spends running automation from the time it spends checking the resulting proofs.

The build covered all 810 tracked library modules, excluding three generator templates, and took **9,415.37 seconds (2 h 36 min 55 s)** in timed build commands. Of these modules, 808 passed. Two unused legacy helpers in real Clifford+CH failed, `ItemBFun` at `omega` proofs and `ItemASteps` at the heartbeat limit. Neither is imported by the main theorem chain or the audit, both of which passed, and the real Clifford+CH entry of Table 1 includes the whole attempted build. Beyond the sixteen development folders, the shared `Circuit`, `Exact`, `Matrix`, and `NumberTheory` folders took 17.91, 15.51, 6.88, and 15.29 seconds, and the five root modules, including the audit, took 54.95 seconds. Lean builds of another project ran on the same machine during part of the run. We therefore re-timed the twenty folders and root modules they overlapped and report the second timing, during which the other project used about a quarter of one CPU on average. The two runs total 9,604 and 9,415 seconds, and the two timings of each development folder agree within 15%, except for Toffoli–Hadamard (178 and 135 seconds).

One proof in both assistants. For Toffoli–Hadamard, the formalizations of Table 1 have 28,629 lines in Agda and 4,401 in Lean, and they prove the result by different routes. The Agda proof replays the derivations in the authors' own files as generated certificates, which make up 22,572 of its lines. The Lean proof was written from the paper, over an alphabet of macro gates, with a Knuth–Bendix system for the symmetric group S_8 that the kernel checks. To compare the two assistants on one proof, Figure 5(a) shows another pair instead (∗). We wrote a second Agda proof of the result, which finds its circuit derivations by a breadth-first search over the relations of Figure 4 of [3], and a coding agent translated it to Lean module for module, keeping its definitions, derivations, and proof route; this time we told the agent to follow the Agda. A coding agent also began translating the first Agda proof in the same way, porting its scripts so that they write the certificates in Lean, and we stopped it after 46 of the 203 modules: the relations, the 218 derivations replayed from the authors' files, the 642 certificates of the permutation fragment, and the frames built on them, 17,862 of the Agda proof's lines. On one proof the two assistants need about the same amount of text: 182,301 non-blank characters outside comments in Agda and 191,589 in Lean for the second proof and its translation, and 1,056,950 and 1,030,864 for the translated modules of the first. In

lines the translation of the second proof is shorter, 5,672 against 7,161, only because its generated derivations put several rewrite steps on a line where Agda's put one, while the translated modules of the first, whose certificates take a step per line in both, are 6% longer, 18,946 against 17,862. The hand-written part of the second proof's translation is the larger of its pair, mostly because it proves the facts about S_8 that the Agda proof imports from the shared library. Lean took 161 seconds to check it and Agda 44, 3.6 times as long, while on the two proofs of Table 1 Lean took 125 seconds and Agda 103, 1.2 times as long. So the pair that Table 1 and Figure 5(b) report reflects the difference between the proofs more than the difference between the assistants. These four times were measured on 8 November 2026 under WSL on an Intel Core i5-14400 with eight logical CPUs and 12 GiB of RAM, by the method of Table 1, with no other proof assistant running.

Execution time. The Agda normal forms are executable functions. The Lean developments obtain normal forms either as existence theorems or as `noncomputable` definitions. For example, the Lean proofs for the Clifford and real stabilizer circuits of [43, 53] show that every circuit equals a normal form without defining a function that computes it, and the exact synthesis of the two-level groups is noncomputable. In all, 460 definitions in the sixteen Lean developments are declared `noncomputable`, so there is no Lean normalizer to time. Both formalizations can, however, execute the procedure that decides whether two circuits have the same matrix, which their soundness proofs run. We compiled this procedure for the Clifford circuits of [53] to native code, through Agda's GHC backend and Lean's C backend. We then timed both on an Intel Core i5-14400, on the same random circuits of 100 gates over H, S, and CZ, deciding that each circuit w has the matrix of $w\,S^4$ (Figure 5(c)). On two qubits Agda is slightly faster, at 5.0 against 5.8 milliseconds per decision. From three qubits on Lean is faster, by a factor of 2.1 on three qubits and 40 on six, where Agda takes 24 seconds and Lean 0.61. The gap comes mostly from the procedures rather than the compilers. Agda computes each circuit's matrix as a product of stored $2^n \times 2^n$ matrices, so its work grows about eightfold with each qubit. Lean simulates the circuit on each basis vector, so its work grows about fourfold.

B Multi-Qupit Clifford Completeness: Formalization Details

This appendix gives the details of the case study in Section 4. We first fix the gate conventions and state the formal theorems (Appendix B.1). We then prove symplectic completeness by normalization (Appendix B.2), restore Paulis and recover the source rule sets (Appendix B.3), and restore scalar phases (Appendix B.4). Appendix B.5 records the implementation and the boundary between the Agda proof and the external identification with unitary groups.

B.1 Gate Conventions, Syntax, and Theorem Statements

We use the gate conventions of Bian, Li et al. [8]. Fix an odd prime p and let $\omega = e^{2\pi i/p}$. On the basis $|0\rangle, \ldots, |p-1\rangle$ indexed by $\mathbb{Z}_p$, the gates $X|j\rangle = |j+1\rangle$ and $Z|j\rangle = \omega^j|j\rangle$ generate, with the phases ω^t, the Pauli group $\mathcal{P}_n$ on n qudits. The gates

$$H\colon |j\rangle \mapsto \frac{\delta_p}{\sqrt{p}} \sum_k \omega^{jk}|k\rangle, \qquad S\colon |j\rangle \mapsto \omega^{j(j-1)/2}|j\rangle, \qquad CZ\colon |j\rangle|l\rangle \mapsto \omega^{jl}|j\rangle|l\rangle$$

generate, with the same phases, the Clifford group C_n. Here $\delta_p = (-i)^{(p-1)/2}$, which makes the determinant of H equal to 1. Modulo scalars, we write $\overline{C}_n = C_n/\langle\omega\rangle$ and $\overline{\mathcal{P}}_n = \mathcal{P}_n/\langle\omega\rangle \cong \mathbb{Z}_p^{2n}$. Then $C_n/\mathcal{P}_n \cong \overline{C}_n/\overline{\mathcal{P}}_n \cong \mathrm{Sp}(2n, \mathbb{Z}_p)$ and $\overline{C}_n \cong \overline{\mathcal{P}}_n \rtimes \mathrm{Sp}(2n, \mathbb{Z}_p)$. We do not formalize these last two isomorphisms, because our semantic groups are *defined* as their right-hand sides. Bian, Li et al. [8] also include -1 among the global phases, so that the swap and the multiplier gates belong to C_n. We work mainly in the projective quotient, where -1 makes no difference and the relations are slightly simpler.

Using the framework of Section 3, we encode circuits, rules, and reasoning with the rules. Figure 6 shows the diagrams for the following encodings. We draw circuits in matrix-multiplication order, the reverse of the usual circuit order, so $w \bullet v$ applies v first but draws it on the right. For example, this is the swap:

```
Ex : Word (Gen (₂₊ n))
Ex = CZ • H ↓ • H ↑ • CZ • H ↓ • H ↑ • CZ • H ↓ • H ↑
```

A rule set is an inductive family indexed by the width, with one constructor per rule. Each rule is stated once, on the bottom wires of every width at which it fits. For example, these are two of the fifteen constructors of our primary rule set _SRel,_===_, the order of the swap and the rule moving H across it:

```
data _SRel,_===_ : (n : ℕ) → WRel (Gen n) where
  order-Ex     : (₂₊ n) SRel, Ex ^ 2 === ε
  semi-Ex-H↑ : (₂₊ n) SRel, Ex • H ↑ === H ↓ • Ex
```

Reasoning with the rules is equational reasoning in the congruence $\approx$ they generate, with combinators for symmetry, associativity, and rewriting the left or right factor of a product. For example, conjugating by the swap moves H down a wire:

```
conj-Ex-H↑ : Ex • H ↑ • Ex ≈ H ↓
conj-Ex-H↑ = begin
  Ex • H ↑ • Ex   ≈⟨ sym assoc ⟩
  (Ex • H ↑) • Ex ≈⟨ cleft axiom semi-Ex-H↑ ⟩
  (H ↓ • Ex) • Ex ≈⟨ assoc ⟩
  H ↓ • Ex • Ex   ≈⟨ cright axiom order-Ex ⟩
  H ↓ • ε         ≈⟨ right-unit ⟩
  H ↓ ■
```

Theorem B.1 (Paper-V1.presentation). *For every width n, the fifteen rules of* `Paper-V1` *(Section B.3) present the projective Clifford model:*

```
presentation : ∀ n → (PapV1.Clifford-Relations._QRel_===_ n) IsPresentationOf (Pauli⋊Sp n)
```

These rules are the relations of Bian, Li et al. [8] read modulo scalars, with its rule (C4) in an equivalent form. The relation _QRel_===_ closes _SRel_===_ under the structural rules (Section 3), and Pauli⋊Sp n is the semidirect product of $\mathbb{Z}_p^{2n}$ by $\mathrm{Sp}(2n, \mathbb{Z}_p)$ (Section B.3). The record _IsPresentationOf_ (Section 3) gives a group isomorphism from circuits modulo $\approx$ to $\overline{\mathcal{P}}_n \rtimes \mathrm{Sp}(2n, \mathbb{Z}_p)$. That this map is well defined is *soundness*, since each rule holds. That it is injective is *completeness*, and that it is surjective says that every element of the model is represented by a circuit.

We refine the normal form of Bian, Li et al. [8] for symplectic operators, which are Clifford operators modulo Paulis, into a doubly inductive definition (Section B.2), and we prove that normal forms are unique:

Theorem B.2 (unique-nf). *Normal forms with equal symplectic denotations are equal:*

```
unique-nf : ∀ n {u v : NF n} → [[ ⌈ u ⌉ ]] ≈ˢ [[ ⌈ v ⌉ ]] → u ≡ v
```

The route. We mostly follow the paper. Its normal boxes, its symplectic normal form, and its parametrized *box relations* reappear below. A box relation says that pushing a gate through a normal box yields an updated box and residual *dirty* gates. We also keep the reduction to eighteen relations of its Theorem 4.4, a step the paper already delegated to Agda. The one major divergence is the step that promotes symplectic to projective completeness, its Proposition 4.9. There, the paper corrects each rule $C_l = C_r$ to $C_l = C_r \,;P$ for the unique Pauli P that makes it projectively sound. It then replays the symplectic rewrites, pushing each correction to the end, where it becomes "a potentially different Pauli". We did not see how to verify this argument at reasonable cost. Instead, we work in a syntax where Paulis are trivial, since symplectic circuits have only H, S, and CZ and denote $\mathrm{Sp}(2n, \mathbb{Z}_p)$ itself. We then reintroduce Paulis and scalars by construction (Figure 10). The Pauli bookkeeping of Proposition 4.9 is thus done once, by a theorem about semidirect products that the framework proves for arbitrary groups.

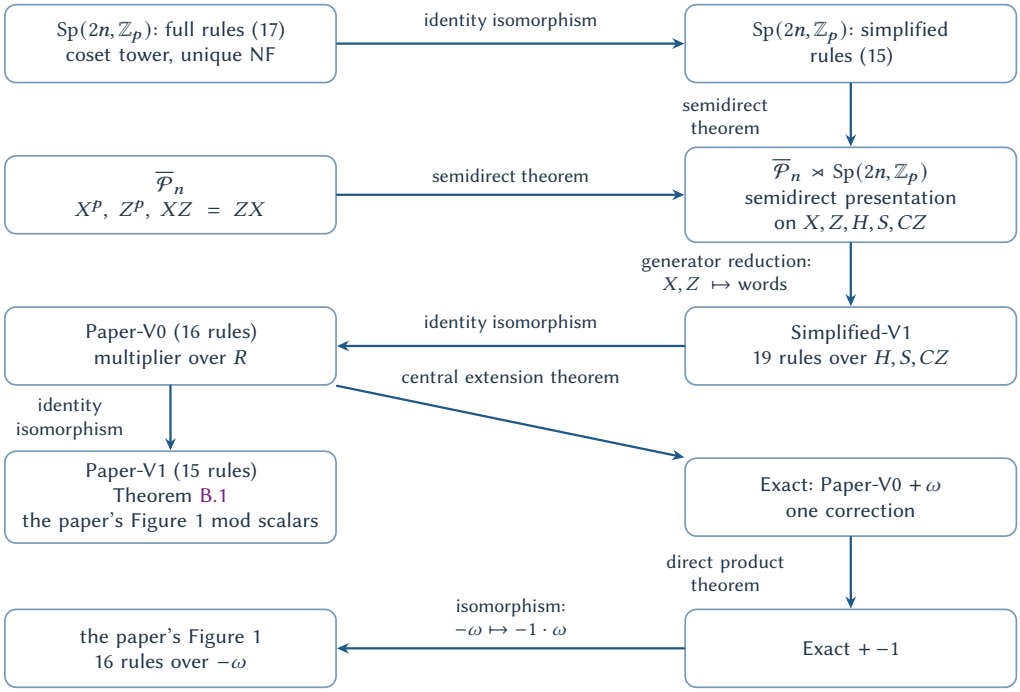


Fig. 10. The chain of presentations used to formalize the qudit Clifford result of Bian, Li et al. [8]. Every arrow is a verified presentation theorem or isomorphism of presentations. The symplectic stages present $\mathrm{Sp}(2n, \mathbb{Z}_p)$, and the projective chain from the semidirect presentation to Paper-V1 presents $\overline{\mathcal{P}}_n \rtimes \mathrm{Sp}(2n, \mathbb{Z}_p)$. "Exact" is a central extension by $\langle\omega\rangle$, and the final two stages also include the direct factor $\langle -1\rangle$.

B.2 Normal Forms for the Symplectic Factor

We now give the datatypes and proof obligations behind Figure 7. We model $\mathrm{Sp}(2n, \mathbb{Z}_p)$ as the group of $\mathbb{Z}_p$-linear bijections of the phase space Pauli n = Vec $(\mathbb{Z}_p \times \mathbb{Z}_p)$ n that preserve the symplectic form. An element of the phase space lists, for each wire, the exponents of $X^a Z^b$ up to phase. Against this semantics, completeness rests on the normal form, which we refine into a doubly inductive datatype:

```
M L ML : ℕ → Set
M 0 = ⊤
M (1+ n) = Vec D n × E
L 0 = ⊤
L (1+ n) = Vec B n × A
ML 0 = ⊤
ML 1 = M 1 × L 1
ML m@(2+ n) = M m × L m
              ⊎ D × ML (1+ n)
```

An M-row is a column of D boxes ending in an E box, the paper's X-normal layer. An L-row is a column of B boxes ending in an A box, its Z-normal layer, with the A box at the bottom. An ML box at width $m \geq 2$ is either a full pair of rows or a bottom D box followed by an ML box one wire

up, so it is a spine of D boxes capped by a pair of rows. This is the first induction, on the width of a single coset representative. The second induction is the staircase:

```
NF : ℕ → Set
NF 0 = ⊤
NF (1+ n) = NF n × ML (1+ n)

[_] : ∀ {n} → NF n → Word (Gen n)
[_] {0}     tt       = ε
[_] {1+ n} (nf , ml) = [ nf ] ↑ • [ ml ]ᵐˡ
```

The table. The coset table is the paper's "push a gate through a normal box", written as a structurally recursive function ract with its soundness law ract-sound (about 5,600 lines together):

```
ract       : ML (1+ n) → Gen (1+ n) → Circuit n × ML (1+ n)
ract-sound : ∀ (c : ML (1+ n)) g → let (b' , c') = ract c g in [ c ]ᶜ • [ g ]ʷ ≈ b' ↑ • [ c' ]ᶜ
```

Each clause of ract-sound is derived from the fifteen simplified symplectic relations. For instance, pushing S through an E box is one step on powers of S, namely $[\,b\,]^{\mathrm{e}} \bullet S = S^{-b} \bullet S \approx S^{-(b-1)} = [\,b-1\,]^{\mathrm{e}}$. A circuit is rewritten to its normal form by repeating this step gate by gate, so every rewrite is traced to a relation.

Uniqueness. The symplectic group acts on Vec Pauli$_1$ n, a $2n$-dimensional symplectic $\mathbb{Z}_p$-vector space in which Pauli$_1$ is the two-dimensional symplectic subspace of a single wire. The elements that fix the bottom wire's subspace pointwise form a copy of $\mathrm{Sp}(2(n-1),\mathbb{Z}_p)$ acting above the bottom wire, and the *ML* boxes represent its cosets. Every $f \in \mathrm{Sp}(2n,\mathbb{Z}_p)$ factors as $f = f' \circ c_n$, with $c_n \in ML_n$ and f' acting above the bottom wire, and c_n is unique because the image of the bottom wire determines the box. Recursing on f' writes f uniquely as $c_1 \circ c_2 \circ \cdots \circ c_n$ with $c_k \in ML_k$, which is Theorem B.2.

Surjectivity. Every symplectic transformation is the action of some circuit. We prove this constructively by clearing the bottom wire and recursing on the rest. This is the paper's Lemma 3.7, with the coset box computed rather than asserted:

```
Theorem-LM : ∀ {n} (p q : Pauli n) → sform p q ≡ ₁ → ∃ λ (lm : ML n) → act [ lm ]ᵐˡ p ≡ pZ₀ × act [ lm ]ᵐˡ q ≡ pX₀
```

Completeness. Circuits with the same denotation rewrite through the table to their normal forms. These normal forms denote the same map by soundness, so they are equal by Theorem B.2, and the circuits are equivalent. This argument is the framework's by-normalization (Figure 3a). With surjectivity, it shows that the simplified relations, which their own module also calls _SRel,_===_, present the symplectic group:

```
presentation : ∀ n → (n SRel,_===_) IsPresentationOf (Sp-group n)
```

B.3 Restoring Paulis and the Source Rule Sets

$\overline{\mathcal{P}}_n \cong (\mathbb{Z}_p \times \mathbb{Z}_p)^n$ is presented over X and Z on each wire by $X^p = Z^p = \varepsilon$ and $ZX = XZ$. Its semantic group is the phase space that $\mathrm{Sp}(2n,\mathbb{Z}_p)$ acts on, and its normal form is $X^a Z^b$ on each wire. Combining this with the symplectic presentation of Section B.2 is an instance of the framework's theorem for semidirect products. The resulting presentation has the relations of both factors together with the conjugation relations $h\,n\,h^{-1} = \mathit{conj}\,h\,n$, where the action conj spells out the paper's Lemmas 2.24–2.25. The theorem asks that the action respect the relations of each factor, and we prove this semantically. The conjugates of congruent words have equal denotations by soundness, so they are congruent by Pauli *completeness*. For symplectic rules this is respects-Δ, and

it corresponds to the paper's "Pauli complete" rules (its Definition 4.7). Since every premise is a theorem, the semidirect presentation of Pauli⋊Sp is unconditional.

Reaching the paper's rules. The semidirect presentation has generators X, Z, H, S, and CZ and $3 + 15 + 14$ relations (Pauli, symplectic, and conjugation), whereas the paper's rule sets have only H, S, and CZ. Three isomorphisms of presentations close this gap (Figure 10), through `Simplified-V1` (nineteen rules), `Paper-V0` (sixteen), and `Paper-V1` (the fifteen of Theorem B.1). Along the way, X and Z become words, and the Pauli and conjugation rules become theorems.

The first isomorphism, from the semidirect presentation to `Simplified-V1`, is between different alphabets. Its map f sends S to $R = S \bullet Z^{1/2}$, and its inverse h sends S to $Z^{-1/2} \bullet S$. In particular, f induces the embedding of the symplectic group into the projective Clifford group. The nineteen rules of `Simplified-V1` are the fifteen simplified symplectic rules together with $(SH)^3 = \varepsilon$, $H^2SH^2S = SH^2SH^2$, and the two rules pushing X through CZ. From these, f-well-defined derives the images under f of the three Pauli rules and the fourteen conjugation rules.

The second isomorphism, from `Simplified-V1` to `Paper-V0`, is the identity on circuits. The two rule sets share six rules word for word and three more up to the spelling of the multiplier, and each derives the rest of the other. The larger direction is `Paper-V0`'s module `Lemmas`, of about 4,750 lines.

The third isomorphism, from `Paper-V0` to `Paper-V1`, changes how the multiplier $M_x \colon |j\rangle \mapsto |xj\rangle$ is spelled as a word. `Paper-V0` spells it over R, as $M_x = R^{x^{-1}} H R^x H R^{x^{-1}} H$. The paper's (T1) spells it over S, up to a phase, as $M_x =$ SHS' $x\ x^{-1}$, where SHS' $a\ b = Z^{(b-1)/2} X^{(1-a)/2} S^b H S^a H S^b H$. Over S, the rule semi-MR reads $M_g S^{g^2} Z^{(g^2-g)/2} = S M_g$. `Paper-V1` restates the four multiplier rules over SHS' and drops one rule. Since M_1 is now the word $(SH)^3$, M-power at $k = 0$ already gives $(SH)^3 \approx \varepsilon$. Over R, M_1 is the different word $(RH)^3$, so that axiom had to stay. The bridge $R^a H R^b H R^a H \approx$ SHS' $b\ a$ for $ab = 1$ (`Shared.PauliBase`) carries the multiplier rules across, which gives Theorem B.1. The paper's own rule (C4) states the conjugation of S by M_g in the other direction. Each of (C4) and semi-MR derives the other (SemiMS), so Figure 1 of Bian, Li et al. [8] read modulo scalars is isomorphic to `Paper-V1`.

B.4 Restoring Scalar Phases

The theorem extension-presentation extends a projective presentation by a scalar. We apply it to `Paper-V0`, which has order-SH as an axiom. We add ω with $\omega^p = \varepsilon$, let ω commute with every gate, and *correct* each rule by its scalar. The correction is ε except on order-SH, the one rule that does not hold exactly, since $(SH)^3 = \omega^{-1/8}$. The exponent $-1/8$ is computed in $\mathbb{Z}_p$, where it equals $(p^2-1)/8$. The multiplier words now denote $|j\rangle \mapsto |xj\rangle$ only up to a scalar.

The semantic extension is the Weyl cocycle on the natural semidirect product, $c((P,A),(Q,B)) = \frac{1}{2}\,\mathrm{sform}(P,\ A \cdot Q)$. Here $A \cdot Q$ is the symplectic part acting on the Pauli vector, and sform is the symplectic form of the phase space, the exponent in $PQ = \omega^{\mathrm{sform}(P,Q)}\, QP$. The cocycle identity follows from the bilinearity and the symplectic invariance of sform. The cocycle of the presented group is the pullback of c along the presentation by `Paper-V0`, so the two agree by construction. The identification with unitary operators uses Weyl multiplication [32, Eq. (4), Theorem 3] and a *linear* Weil representation with exact covariance [33, Theorem 1.3.2]. The operators $U(e,v,A) = \omega^e W(v)\rho(A)$ satisfy

$$U(e,v,A)\,U(f,w,B) = U\big(e + f + \tfrac{1}{2}\mathrm{sform}(v,Aw),\ v + Aw,\ AB\big).$$

This is the Heisenberg–Weil representation [34, §1.3]. Conjugation on Weyl operators determines A and v, so the representation is faithful and its scalars are exactly $\langle \omega I \rangle$ (at width zero, $e \mapsto \omega^e$).

Adjoining $-I$ gives its direct product with $\mathbb{Z}_2$, whose scalars are $\langle -\omega I \rangle$. These finite phase choices differ from the full unitary normalizer, which contains $U(1)$. With no hypotheses, we obtain:

```
presentation-exact : ∀ n → (n Exact._===_) IsPresentationOf (PE.Presented-group n (exact-generator-data n))
```

Agda also shows that the trivial cocycle cannot realize the correction of order-SH (split-forces).

The rules as printed. Figure 1 of Bian, Li et al. [8] is stated over $-\omega$. Its multipliers carry Legendre symbols and its swap carries the sign $(-1)^{(p-1)/2}$, so it needs the -1 that the exact group lacks, since the scalars of that group have odd order. Adjoining -1 as a central involution presents the exact group times $\mathbb{Z}_2$, which is Clifford±. Figure 1 is isomorphic to this rule set by $-\omega \mapsto -1 \cdot \omega$, where the scalar of each exact rule is determined by reading its lift back. This is the paper's Theorem 4.10, stated against our group:

```
presentation-Figure1 : ∀ n → (n F._===_) IsPresentationOf (Clifford± n)
```

B.5 Implementation and Semantic Boundary

This development is checked by Agda 2.8 with standard library 2.4 under `--safe`, with no postulates and no holes. The development has 215 modules and about 58,000 lines of code, of which about 27,000 are for the symplectic group, 18,000 for the projective chain, and 13,000 for the scalars. These counts exclude the shared library (Appendix A).

The Agda development does not formalize the two isomorphisms of Section B.1 [32, 33], and no matrix appears in it. The representation argument above is external mathematics, and matching the paper's gate phases remains a convention check [8, 46]. The Lean development needs neither, since it proves soundness and completeness against complex matrices directly (Appendix A).

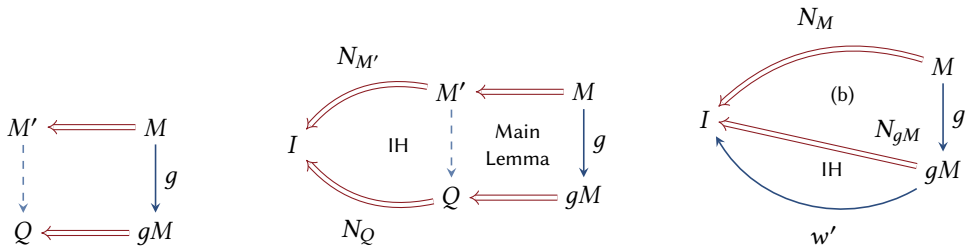
We used versions of Claude for parts of this formalization: composing box relations to prove ract-sound, defining the symplectic group, and establishing the equivalence between the code's relations and those in Figure 1 of Bian, Li et al. [8], read modulo scalars. Claude also wrote presentation-exact and the layer for Figure 1 with -1.

C Completeness from Exact Synthesis

For the matrix groups discussed in Section 2, normal forms come from exact synthesis, and the proof that every circuit can be transformed into its normal form has the same structure for each algorithm. Each matrix, or *state*, has a *level*, built from quantities such as the least denominator exponent of a column, and the algorithm reduces each state M to the identity in steps that lower the level. These steps form the normal word N_M.

The *Main Lemma* says that for every state M and generator g, a diagram of relations closes the square formed by g and the algorithm's next steps from M and gM, passing only through states of lower level (Figure 11a).

By well-founded induction on the level, the relations then rewrite $N_{gM}\, g$ into N_M (Figure 11b), and by induction on length, every word that reduces M to the identity rewrites into N_M (Figure 11c). Two words with the same matrix therefore rewrite into each other. These inductions have the same form for every presentation, so the main work in each formalization is its Main Lemma.



(a) The Main Lemma. (b) Induction on the level. (c) Induction on length.

Fig. 11. Completeness from the Main Lemma. Plain arrows are words, double arrows are steps or runs of the algorithm, and dashed arrows are words through states of lower level.

D QCert Implementation Details

This appendix gives the circuit encoding, theorem notation, and matrix equality procedure used by the framework in Section 3.

D.1 Wire Placement and Structural Rules

Wires are numbered from 0 at the bottom, and a gate acts on the bottom wires of a circuit. A shift places a circuit on n wires onto wires $1, \ldots, n$ of a circuit with $n + 1$ wires. In the matrix semantics, both placing a gate in a larger circuit and shifting a circuit are Kronecker products with an identity. This defines wire placement once for all gate sets.

Each source relation is stated on as many wires as the paper draws it on. Structural rules allow an equation to be shifted by one wire, gates on disjoint wires to commute, and a scalar to be placed on any wire. QCert extends the earlier framework's one- and two-wire syntax with three-wire gates and their structural rule. Scalars are zero-wire generators; their placement rule allows exact equations to account for global phase.

In the earlier framework, swap is an ordinary gate whose laws must be included in each rule set. QCert also supports a PROP presentation, in which a designated two-wire gate is the swap and the framework supplies its involution law and the laws for moving gates across it. The source rule set then contains only its own relations, each on its original wires; swap and its laws are supplied by the framework. We use this representation for the circuits of [1, 13, 14].

D.2 Theorem Notation

The signatures in Section 3 use `n CRel,_===_` for relations on circuits with n wires and `n MRel,_===_` for relations on words over multi-level matrices of dimension n. In Statement (1), the former contains R1–R16 of Figure 1 of [43], lifted to n wires. In Statement (2), the latter contains the relations of Figure 6 of Hadamard-Π [26].

The judgement `⊢ w ≈ v` states that w and v are equal by the relations. The qubit developments interpret matrices in $\mathbb{D}[\omega]$ and use `_≈ᵁ_` for their equality; the qudit developments compare interpretations in their own groups. The `IsSubPresentationOf` record contains the semantics and its soundness and completeness proofs, and `IsPresentationOf` adds surjectivity.

Minimality is stated for the rule set `n ⊢_===_` in Statement (5). Unlike the generated equivalence relation, this retains the individual rules, so removing one is defined. The predicate `IsMinimal` therefore takes this rule set rather than its generated equivalence relation.

D.3 Matrix Equality Checking

The main computational cost came from Agda's conversion checker. It accepts syntactically identical terms immediately; otherwise, it evaluates them to compare their results. For long matrix products, this evaluation can take exponential time. We keep circuit interpretations abstract and decide matrix equality by computing a single Boolean using row operations. For these products, this is orders of magnitude faster than comparing matrices entry by entry. These techniques are included in the agents' instructions so that later formalizations avoid the same slowdowns.